TOPS Technologies

Interview Questions — Advanced Excel For Analytics

Total Questions: 78

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1. What is the difference between a worksheet and a workbook in Excel?

> **Hint:** One is a single sheet, the other is a collection.

2. Explain the purpose of the Excel ribbon and how it helps users navigate Excel's features.

3. What is a cell reference in Excel, and how does A1 notation differ from R1C1 notation?

> **Hint:** Think about how rows and columns are labeled in each mode.

4. When would you use an absolute cell reference like A1 instead of a relative reference like A1?

> **Hint:** Consider what happens when you copy a formula to another cell.

5. List at least three different data types that Excel cells can store. Give an example of each.

6. If you see the error #VALUE! in a cell, what does it typically mean?

> **Hint:** It's often related to incompatible data types in a formula.

7. How would you identify and correct incorrect data types in a raw Excel dataset?

8. What is a named range in Excel, and how can it make formulas easier to read?

9. Describe the difference between static and dynamic named ranges.

> **Hint:** One updates automatically when data is added, the other does not.

10. How would you set up a data validation rule to allow only dates from 2020 onwards in a column?

> **Hint:** Think about the data validation options for dates.

11. Explain how to create a dropdown list for 'Product Category' in Excel.

12. What is the purpose of sorting data in Excel, and how do you perform a multi-level sort?

> **Hint:** Multi-level sorting organizes data by more than one column.

13. How is an AutoFilter different from an Advanced Filter in Excel?

14. Which steps would you follow to filter records where Sales > 5000 and Region = 'East' using Advanced Filter?

15. How can you remove all blank rows from a dataset in Excel?

16. What is a criteria range in Advanced Filtering, and how does it help with complex conditions?

17. Describe how to copy filtered results to a new location in Excel.

18. What are custom views in Excel and when would you use them?

19. How does the LEFT function work in Excel? Give an example.

20. Write an Excel formula to extract the last two characters from the text 'TX-2345'.

21. If you have the text 'Mobile-Apple', how would you extract only the word 'Mobile' using a text function?

> **Hint:** Think about which function returns a specified number of characters from the start.

22. What does the TRIM function do in Excel, and why is it useful for cleaning data?

23. How would you convert the messy name ' rAhUl shaH ' to 'Rahul Shah' using Excel functions?

> **Hint:** You might need to use more than one text function.

24. Explain the difference between SUBSTITUTE and REPLACE functions in Excel.

25. What is the TODAY() function used for in Excel?

26. Write a formula to calculate the age of an employee given their birthdate in cell A2.

> **Hint:** Consider using TODAY() and the YEAR function.

27. How can you calculate the number of working days between two dates in Excel?

> **Hint:** There is a function that excludes weekends and optionally holidays.

28. What is the difference between IF and IFS functions in Excel?

29. Write a formula using nested IF to assign grades: A for marks >=90, B for marks >=75, else C.

30. How would you use the AND and OR functions inside an IF statement?

31. What is VLOOKUP used for in Excel, and what are its main limitations?

> **Hint:** Think about lookup direction and what happens if the lookup column moves.

32. Write a VLOOKUP formula to find the price of a product based on its name from a products table.

33. What is the difference between an exact match and an approximate match in VLOOKUP?

34. How is XLOOKUP different from VLOOKUP, and what advantages does it provide?

35. Write an XLOOKUP formula to find the last bonus received by an employee, searching from bottom to top.

36. How can you handle errors in XLOOKUP to display 'Not Found' if there is no match?

37. Explain how the INDEX and MATCH functions can be combined to perform a two-way lookup.

38. Write a formula to return the sales value for Region = 'West' and Month = 'March' using INDEX and MATCH.

39. Why might you prefer INDEX-MATCH over VLOOKUP in some scenarios?

40. What is conditional formatting in Excel, and how can it help highlight important data?

41. Describe how you would highlight all duplicate values in a column using conditional formatting.

42. How would you use conditional formatting to color-code revenue above a target in green and below the target in red?

43. What are pivot tables, and why are they useful for data analysis?

44. List the main components of a pivot table and explain their roles.

45. How would you summarize sales by region and category using a pivot table?

46. Explain how grouping by date in a pivot table can help identify trends.

47. What are calculated fields in pivot tables, and why might you use them?

48. How do slicers enhance the interactivity of pivot tables and dashboards?

49. Describe how you would create an interactive executive dashboard in Excel using pivot charts and slicers.

50. What is the purpose of timelines in Excel dashboards, and how do they differ from slicers?

> **Hint:** Think about which type is best for filtering by dates.

51. How would you remove duplicate records from a dataset in Excel?

52. Explain how the Text to Columns feature works and give an example of when you'd use it.

53. What is Flash Fill, and how can it save time during data cleaning?

54. How can you use wildcards when replacing text in Excel?

55. Describe a scenario where you would use the error-checking tools on the ribbon.

56. What types of charts can you create from a pivot table, and when would you use each type?

57. How do you format a pivot chart for a professional dashboard appearance?

58. What is Power Query, and how does it help with importing and cleaning data in Excel?

59. List the basic steps you would follow to load a CSV file, clean the data, and load it back to Excel using Power Query.

60. Explain the difference between merging and appending queries in Power Query.

61. How would you resolve column mismatches when merging two tables in Power Query?

> **Hint:** Consider what happens if column names or data types differ.

62. Describe the steps to create a dashboard layout with header, KPIs, trends, and insights.

63. What are KPI cards, and how would you use them to display min, max, and average values in a dashboard?

64. How can color theory and alignment principles improve the readability of your Excel dashboard?

65. Walk me through how you would approach building a dashboard for a retail sales dataset from scratch.

66. In a case study project, how would you decide which Excel functions and features to use for data cleaning and analysis?

67. What is a macro in Excel, and how can it help automate repetitive tasks?

68. Describe the steps to record a macro that cleans and formats a dataset.

69. What is the difference between a regular Excel file (.xlsx) and a macro-enabled file (.xlsm)?

70. What is the VBA Editor, and what basic tasks can you perform there?

71. Write a simple VBA code snippet to loop through all worksheets and set the font size of all cells to 12.

72. How would you handle errors in a VBA automation script to prevent Excel from crashing?

73. Describe how you would add a button to a worksheet that runs a macro to refresh all data and export a dashboard as PDF.

74. During a dashboard automation project, how would you ensure the macros update Power Query, refresh pivots, and apply formatting in the right order?

75. Given a large retail sales dataset, how would you use Excel to identify the most profitable region and product category?

76. How would you use Excel dashboards to present insights and trends to a manager who is not familiar with Excel?

> **Hint:** Think about clarity, visuals, and key takeaways.

77. How could you use AI tools like ChatGPT or Microsoft Copilot to help you write Excel formulas or VBA code, and what should you check before using their suggestions?

> **Hint:** Consider accuracy, context, and testing.

78. If you are building a dashboard and want to speed up the design or analysis process, how might AI-powered features in Excel or external tools assist you? Where would you still rely on your own judgment?

> **Hint:** Think about automation versus understanding the data and story.
